

Our topic today is the believer in immaterial souls view that
we are (either wholly or in part) immaterial things.

You may recall that we came up with two believer in
immaterial souls answers to the identity question:



**Simple
dualism: I am
an immaterial
soul**

A solid blue circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is centered and reads: "Fusion dualism: I am a combination of a soul and a body".

Fusion
dualism: I am
a combination
of a soul
and a body

**Soul
survival:**

X is me just in
case X is the
same immaterial
soul as me

Fusion survival:

X is me just in case X
has the same immaterial
soul as me and is the
same material thing as
me

For right now we're going to set aside the question of which of these views is better.

Instead, we're going to ask a more fundamental question: is there any good reason to believe in the existence of immaterial souls?

Most of us don't believe in fairies, there being no good evidence for their existence. Why should souls be any different?

We're going to look at two different arguments for the
existence of souls.

Properties related to conscious experience include the property of feeling an itch or a pain, or the sensation of seeing red or hearing a loud noise. These properties are sometimes called **phenomenal properties**.

Human beings (obviously) have phenomenal properties — we
experience all kinds of sensations.

We're going to look at two. The first turns on the idea that immaterial souls are needed to explain the nature of **consciousness.**

Suppose that we were wholly physical things (as both the organism view and the brain view say). What would that imply about the nature of our phenomenal properties?

The following principles seem plausible:

Wholly physical things have only
physical properties.

But then it seems to follow from the fact that we have
phenomenal properties that

If we are wholly physical things,
then phenomenal properties are
physical properties.

We'll now look at an argument that phenomenal properties are **not** physical properties — which, given the above, would show that we are not wholly physical things.

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This seems to be a statement of the general principle that if

properties must be physical properties.

human beings are wholly physical things, then all of their

“If a human person is a physical thing, any change whatever in a human person must be a purely physical change. If, for example, Tim becomes elated because of some news contained in a letter he has just received, this change in Tim, his becoming elated, must be the very same thing as some purely physical change.”

What materialist theories of person imply about phenomenal

properties? Here is what Peter van Inwagen says:

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